Time and Modality

Fall 2025 · Uppsala University

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COURSE DESCRIPTION

What is time, and what does it mean to say that something is possible or necessary? This course investigates these fundamental questions from both metaphysical and logical perspectives. We will discuss topics such as the nature of temporal reality, the openness of the future, temporal experience, modality, possible worlds, and the relationship between time and modality. Readings are drawn from both classic and contemporary sources, with an emphasis on how recent work in metaphysics and philosophy of language approaches these issues.

REQUIRED TEXTS

There is no required text to purchase. All readings will be made available through the course modules section on Studium.

ASSESSMENT

The main assignment for the course is a **3,000–4,000 word philosophy paper** on a topic related to the course. Before submitting the final paper, you must submit a **500–800 word extended abstract.** The abstract should clearly state your topic and preliminary thesis and outline the structure of your planned argument.

ASSIGNMENT	LENGTH	DUE	GRADING
Extended abstract	500–800 words	Friday, 5 December 2025, 17:00 CET	Pass/Fail
Final paper	3,000–4,000 words	Friday, 12 December 2025, 17:00 CET	

Further details about both assignments are available on Studium.

To pass the course, you must receive a passing grade on both the paper abstract and the final paper. Your final grade is determined primarily by the grade on your final paper.

Class attendance is not required, and failing to attend class will not negatively affect your grade. However, strong class participation may positively influence your final grade.

SCHEDULE

1	TBA	**Introduction**
2	TBA	**Presentism and Eternalism**
3	TBA	**3D and 4D**
4	TBA	**Time Travel**

PLAGIARISM

Your work must be your own, and it is your responsibility as a student to know what counts as plagiarism. For more information, see https://www.uu.se/en/students/your-rights/examination/cheating-and-plagiarism.

RE-EXAMINATION

Students who do not receive a passing grade on the final paper are invited to submit a new or revised version during one of the re-examination periods:

- **First re-examination:** Monday, 19 January 2026 (09:00) – Friday, 23 January 2026 (17:00 CET)
- **Second re-examination:** Monday, 10 August 2026 (09:00) – Friday, 14 August 2026 (17:00 CET)